



Mekorama

Many games after Monument Valley tried to capture the charming storytelling and captivating game design perfected in it but none succeeded quite as well as Mekorama. This game not only does justice to the aesthetics first exemplified by Monument Valley but really raises the bar to a whole new level. And there is no need to worry about your phone memory while getting this one, the entire game is packaged in just 5.2MB! There are no ads and no in-app purchases. The most you will encounter in lieu of ads is a request from the developer to repay his efforts.

Mekorama features a dazed, dizzy robot who must make his way to goals scattered across elaborately designed levels or 'mechanical dioramas'. These levels feature blocks of water, movable parts activated by buttons, stairs and little patches of greenery built from the bottom up. The protagonist is adorably designed and his shaky steps as he follows your directions make him even more endearing. The graphics are gorgeous with crisp details and clean lines adding a sense of solidity to its world.

An awesome feature of this game is the ability to create your own levels and share them with others using a unique QR code. This makes the game potential-

ly infinite. The level creator is immensely easy to use and anybody can make a new level within minutes. The best part of the game is that it actually challenges your mind. While the puzzles in Monument Valley were mostly based on optical illusions, those in Mekorama rely on simple interconnected mechanics. If you play only one puzzle game this month, let it be Mekorama. It is well worth it.

Cosmic Challenge

Cosmic Challenge features an expansive world of asteroids and planets where the racing track is not just dangerous, it is interstellar. The tracks wind about asteroids and barrel-roll near stars. The game controls are a bit iffy for a mobile game, however, you might not take much time to become comfortable with the new controls and when you do, you will relish how responsive the ship is to your every tap and tilt. Cosmic Challenge is a rewarding game in the long run because you will actually have to build your skills to get better at it. Many mobile games require you to just

shut-off and press a button mindlessly which ends up yielding an experience which, while not being very challenging, showers the player with points for instant gratification.

Cosmic Challenge, however, does no such thing. You will have to fight your way to the top rung of the extra-terrestrial racing

ladder. There are plenty of ships and upgrades available in the in-game store. A great plus point, also one that it share with Mekorama, is the ability to create your own levels. The game is almost as fun as Riptide.

Cosmic Challenge is the game for you if you are tired of racing on just plain ground. Why race on Earth when you can race among the stars?



Big Hunter

Big Hunter is a minimalist game about hunting down a mammoth, not a task to be undertaken very lightly. The story behind Big Hunter is that the leader of a Bushman tribe has to venture into the outback and hunt a

mammoth every day in order to provide food to his tribe. Before going any further, we must address the elephant in the room. Yes, the premise is fraught with historical inaccuracies but who cares as long as the game is fun. Which it is, incidentally. If you thought to fight with a big, hairy pachyderm would be boring, you were wrong! The brave tribal leader ventures into the outback every single day and faces the murderous beast with a cautious smile on his face.

The design is minimalist, and the soundtrack is upbeat and lively.

There are only two controls, a tap to make the hunter retreat and another pull back and release mechanism to aim the

spear right into the mammoth's head. The health points of the mammoth increase with every day and it becomes progressively harder to kill. Along with this, the game adds different restrictions like time or limits the number of spears you can use to add some more intrigue to the game.

The tricky part here is timing the retreat and the launch of the spear carefully so no weapon is wasted by getting deflected by the tusks of the woolly beast. The mammoth gets more and more enraged the lower its health goes and comes charging after the hunter. If you are not quick to retreat, the mauled mammoth tosses you around. What fun!

